Forecast and alert sources

Every outside service El Nino Watch uses to forecast rain and river flow, to raise alerts, and to check those alerts against what has been observed in Somalia.

Each entry says what the app uses it for.

Checked against the app on 16 October 2026.

Official national source: Somali National Hydrological Services (MOEWR)

The Ministry of Energy and Water Resources publishes the national flood forecast the app shows as official alerts. ICPAC's regional forecasts, Google Flood Hub's river forecasts and GDACS event monitoring are not official warnings, and the app labels them that way.

Forecasts

5 sources

Open-Meteo Weather Forecast API

Open-Meteo

Daily and hourly rainfall forecasts for all 30 cities. The app's server fetches them once and shares them with every visitor. These are computer model estimates, not station measurements.

ABOUT	https://open-meteo.com/en/docs
API	https://api.open-meteo.com/v1/forecast

Open-Meteo Flood API

GloFAS river discharge, via Open-Meteo

River discharge forecast for each city.

ABOUT	https://open-meteo.com/en/docs/flood-api
API	https://flood-api.open-meteo.com/v1/flood

ICPAC Weekly Exceptional Rainfall Forecast

Also alerts

IGAD Climate Prediction and Applications Centre

Heavy, very heavy and extremely heavy rainfall forecasts for the week (above the 90th, 95th and 99th percentiles for that week of the year). Drives the Alerts tab and the rainfall layers on the flood map.

ABOUT	https://www.icpac.net/weekly-forecast/
PORTAL	https://eahazardswatch.icpac.net/
DATA	https://eahazardswatch.icpac.net/api/datasets/
MAP LAYERS	https://eahazardswatch.icpac.net/mapserver/

ENSO Diagnostic Discussion
NOAA Climate Prediction Center

The current El Niño status and outlook.

ABOUT https://www.cpc.ncep.noaa.gov/products/analysis_monitoring/enso_advisory/ensodisc.shtml

Weekly Niño sea-surface temperature index
NOAA Climate Prediction Center

Weekly El Niño ocean temperatures.

DATA https://www.cpc.ncep.noaa.gov/data/indices/wksst9120.for

The app also links to meteoblue's Galkayo forecast for comparison. It does not use meteoblue's data.

COMPARE https://www.meteoblue.com/en/weather/today/gaalkacyo_somalia_59611

Alerts and event monitoring

4 sources

Somali National Hydrological Services Official
Ministry of Energy and Water Resources (MOEWR)

The official national flood forecast: each region's daily flood level (advisory, watch or warning) for the active rainy season, with anticipatory-action pre-activation and activation. Shown as official alerts for the cities in each region.

PORTAL https://hydro.tekhub.so/

Google Flood Hub
Google Research · Flood Forecasting API

River flood forecasts at river gauges, from Google's AI model. A gauge forecast at Flood Hub's Warning, Danger or Extreme level within 25 km of a monitored city becomes an alert for that city. A model forecast, not an official warning. Used once Google approves the app's access to the API; the data is under the CC BY 4.0 licence.

PORTAL https://sites.research.google/floods/
API https://floodforecasting.googleapis.com/v1/
GUIDE https://developers.google.com/flood-forecasting

GDACS
Global Disaster Alert and Coordination System

Flood and other disaster events affecting Somalia, shown as event monitoring.

ABOUT https://www.gdacs.org/
API https://www.gdacs.org/gdacsapi/api/events/geteventlist/SEARCH
GUIDE https://gdacs.org/Documents/2025/GDACS_API_quickstart_v1.pdf

ICPAC Weekly Exceptional Rainfall Forecast
Listed under Forecasts

Rainfall alerts for each city, from the forecast above.

PORTAL https://eahazardswatch.icpac.net/

Observations that support the alerts

5 sources

What has actually been measured or seen from satellites, used to check forecasts and alerts against conditions on the ground.

SWALIM river stations

FAO Somalia Water and Land Information Management

Observed river levels on the Juba and Shabelle, compared with flood thresholds.

STATIONS	https://snrfa.faoswalim.org/stations/
FRRIMS	https://frrims.faoswalim.org/

Global Flood Monitoring (GFM)

Copernicus Emergency Management Service

Flood extent mapped from Sentinel-1 radar.

ABOUT	https://extwiki.eodc.eu/GFM/PUM
MAP LAYERS	https://geoserver.gfm.eodc.eu/geoserver/gfm/wms

Global Flood Product

NASA, served through NASA GIBS

3-day flood map layers from the MODIS and VIIRS satellites.

ABOUT	https://www.earthdata.nasa.gov/global-flood-product
MAP LAYERS	https://gibs.earthdata.nasa.gov/wmts/epsg3857/best/1.0.0/WMTSCapabilities.xml

Copernicus Data Space Ecosystem

Sentinel-1 and Sentinel-2 imagery

The latest satellite pass over each city, with a link to view the image.

BROWSER	https://browser.dataspace.copernicus.eu/
CATALOGUE	https://stac.dataspace.copernicus.eu/v1/
GUIDE	https://documentation.dataspace.copernicus.eu/APIs/STAC.html

SWALIM flood maps

FAO SWALIM spatial data catalogue

Reference layers: terrain flood susceptibility (30 m), past flood areas 2013–2023, Shabelle riverbank breakages (August 2026 assessment) and Juba riverbank breakages (March 2026 assessment).

SUSCEPTIBILITY	https://spatial.faoswalim.org/catalogue/#/dataset/609
PAST FLOODS	https://spatial.faoswalim.org/catalogue/#/dataset/295
SHABELLE	https://spatial.faoswalim.org/catalogue/#/dataset/607
JUBA	https://spatial.faoswalim.org/catalogue/#/dataset/481

Public health guidance

6 sources

The public health alert at the bottom of the Alerts tab and the cholera film are based on these World Health Organization documents. They are guidance, not outbreak reports.

Cholera: protect your family

Film

El Nino Watch film · English and Somali

A narrated film on preventing cholera: safe water, handwashing, latrines, safe food and ORS. It plays in the reader's language and is based on the WHO cholera fact sheet and WHO's floods guidance below.

FILM elninowatch.so/#health-film

Global Public Health Situation Analysis, El Niño 2026

World Health Organization (WHO)

Lists cholera and other waterborne disease, dengue, malaria and Rift Valley fever as high or very high risks for Somalia (printed page 14).

REPORT https://cdn.who.int/media/docs/default-source/meeting-reports/global-public-health-situation-analysis-el-nino-2026_.pdf

Somalia Health Emergency Appeal 2025

World Health Organization (WHO)

Describes cholera in Somalia, and malaria and dengue spreading to new districts as a direct result of flooding.

APPEAL https://www.who.int/publications/m/item/somalia--who-health-emergency-appeal-2025

Floods: how to protect your health

World Health Organization (WHO)

Explains contaminated drinking water, mosquitoes after floods, and preventing cholera, typhoid and malaria.

Q&A https://www.who.int/news-room/q-a-detail/how-do-i-protect-my-health-in-a-flood

Water, sanitation and health in humanitarian emergencies

World Health Organization (WHO)

Covers infections linked to poor sanitation: diarrhoeal diseases, dysentery, hepatitis A and E, and skin infections.

PAGE https://www.who.int/teams/environment-climate-change-and-health/water-sanitation-and-health/environmental-health-in-emergencies/humanitarian-emergencies

Rift Valley fever

World Health Organization (WHO)

Links outbreaks in East Africa to El Niño heavy rainfall, and explains infection from livestock and mosquitoes and how to prevent it.

FACT SHEET https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/rift-valley-fever

Cholera

World Health Organization (WHO)

Explains contaminated food and water, rapid dehydration, ORS treatment, sanitation and vaccination.

FACT SHEET https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/cholera

Privacy

What El Nino Watch keeps about you, and who else sees what. There are no accounts, no cookies and no advertising, and nothing is sold.

Visit counts

Each page load is counted, with the tab, city, language, type of device and the country the connection comes from. No cookies, internet addresses or browser details are stored, and browsers that ask not to be tracked are not counted. The totals are shown on the visitor statistics page.

Community reports

Reports and comments are public: what you write, the name or alias you give (or Anonymous), any location you add, and photos or videos exactly as uploaded, which may contain location data. Your internet address is held in memory for up to 10 minutes to limit abuse, and is never saved. Only the browser that sent a report can delete it, using a receipt kept in that browser.

WhatsApp alerts

If you sign up, your WhatsApp number, the cities you follow and your language are kept only to send the alerts. Messages go through Meta's WhatsApp service. Replying STOP deletes them.

Saved in your browser

Your language, home city, added cities, report receipts, alerts already shown, city manager review stages and private notes are saved in your own browser, not sent to El Nino Watch. Clearing the site's data in your browser removes them.

Other services

Forecasts, alerts and news are fetched by the El Nino Watch server, so those services do not see you. The flood map's layers and the place-name search for added cities load directly from their publishers, who see your internet address as any website does. Share buttons contact X or Facebook only when you tap them. The site is hosted on bunny.net, which handles every request as any web host does.

Questions about privacy: contact@mandekconsulting.com

Not listed: the base map and elevation services (Natural Earth, Esri World Imagery, Open-Meteo Elevation and place-name search), which draw the map but do not forecast or alert.

Community reports in the app come from residents and are unverified.